contrary to their tacit exhortations to Pakistan to fight on, a ceasefire was already being negotiated. A ceasefire was declared after UN intervention on 23 September 1965. The formal ceasefire agreement known as the Tashkent Agreement was signed on 19 January 1966 and by 26 February 1966, both armies had pulled back to ground positions they previously held. Once again, India surrendered and allowed the recapture of her own territory in Jammu and Kashmir. History repeats itself.

The Master Cell Is Born

Like history, patterns repeat themselves as well. According to author Praveen Swami, as explained in his book, *India, Pakistan and the Secret Jihad: The Covert War in Kashmir, 1947–2004*, the ambiguity of the National Conference towards accession to India manifested itself in March 1964 in the form of certain fringe elements in the organisation establishing the Students' Federation (SF) and Young Men's League (YML) to push the case for separation from India more aggressively.[12] Three SF and YML members, Ashraf Batku, Bashir Ahmed Kitchloo and Zafar-ul-Islam, along with another valley resident-turned-Pakistani spy, Ghulam Sarwar, set up what was called the Master Cell to supervise their covert campaign against Indian rule in Jammu and Kashmir.

Within two weeks of the launch of Operation Gibraltar on 5 August 1965, the Master Cell started printing and posting anti-India posters on the streets of Srinagar. On 29 August 1965, it organised a students' strike in Srinagar. They also set off a grenade, carrying the Pakistan Ordnance Factories' seal, on the same day in Srinagar's Regal Chowk. On 6 September 1965, they also convinced the students of the Government Medical College to go on a strike. On 11 September 1965, another grenade was let off in Lal Chowk. More grenade attacks followed and the campaign of terror unleashed by the Master Cell continued. These activities ran concurrently with the 1965 Indo-Pak War. However, Indian intelligence caught on to the tracks of the Master Cell and by early 1966, it was shut down.